

Challenge Accepted

I think one major reason I became an engineer is because in high school, I favored science and math classes over classes where there wasn't a way to get to a concrete answer. Initially, I wanted to attend college to become a nurse or a doctor, but thankfully, before it was too late, I discovered that bodily fluids make me woozy. As an alternative, Biomedical Engineering was a perfect fit for me because I could help people by designing medical devices.

I wanted to go to the University of Texas at Austin. I did not meet all the acceptance criteria, and only 1% of applicants are accepted, so I thought "challenge accepted!" I got in and graduated as a Biomedical Engineer in 2009 during a recession when many medical device companies were not hiring. Although, not what I had planned, I accepted a full-time engineering position at National Instruments, which works with a variety of companies, including medical device manufacturers. This work presented a lot of opportunity to be creative, because engineers envision products that don't exist, like electric vehicle batteries , self-driving vehicles for persons without the ability to see, and implantable medical devices.

As prototypes are built, test equipment must also be designed and built. An example of this is when I was a product manager of a project for an automobile manufacturer. I worked with a team to develop a test system for an off-road vehicle that had more than than 200 data logging devices to continuously collect data for over 400 engineers. I presented this success story as a keynote speaker in front of 4000 engineers and scientists from around the world!

Through my career journey, I learned that as an engineer you have to have the flexibility to discover what interests you and design your career around your interests. An engineering degree gives you credibility that you are a problem-solver and can handle any task or project that you decide to take on. Successful engineers push themselves to be life-long learners and grow within their career to be continually challenged.

Stephanie's Journey



Stephanie Amrite
Principal Field Marketer
National Instruments

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